Nonviolent Communication

Four Steps

Step	What It Means
Observation	Say what you see, without judging it.
Feelings	Say how it makes you feel.
Needs	Name the need behind the feeling.
Request	Ask clearly for what would help.

Between Colleagues

Violent Communication	Nonviolent Communication
"You never do your part; you're so lazy!"	"I've noticed some tasks aren't getting done. Can we talk about how to share the workload?"
"This is a stupid idea; it will never work."	"I have some concerns about this idea. Can we look at the challenges together?"
"You're always messing things up!"	"I see a few mistakes in the report. Let's review it together."
"I can't believe you'd say that; you're clueless!"	"I didn't understand your point. Could you explain it further?"
"You need to stop being so difficult."	"I feel frustrated when we disagree. Can we find a better way to communicate?"
"You're just trying to make me look bad."	"I feel uncomfortable when our talks turn into blame. Can we focus on solutions?"
"If you don't change, this team will fail."	"I think we need some changes to improve how the team works. What are your thoughts?"
"You're not qualified to make that decision."	"I think we should hear all sides before deciding. Can we talk it through?"
"You always interrupt me; it's so rude!"	"I feel overlooked when I'm interrupted. Can we let each other finish speaking?"
"This project is doomed because of your mistakes."	"I think we have some challenges with this project. Let's find the issues and work on solutions together."

Leaders

Violent Communication	Nonviolent Communication
"You need to get your act together!"	"I've noticed some challenges in your recent work. How can I support you?"
"This is unacceptable; you're letting the team down!"	"I see some issues with the project. Let's look at how we can fix them together."
"You should know better than to make that mistake!"	"Mistakes happen. Let's review what went wrong and how to prevent it."
"I don't have time to babysit you!"	"I want you to succeed. Let's set up regular check-ins so you have the support you need."
"You're not meeting expectations; this is disappointing."	"I'd like to talk about your performance and align on expectations going forward."
"Why can't you just follow instructions?"	"I noticed some steps were missed. Can we talk about what got in the way?"
"You're always late with your reports!"	"I've noticed the reports are often late. Is there a way to adjust the deadlines or the process?"

Violent Communication	Nonviolent Communication
"If you can't handle this, maybe you're in the wrong job."	"I believe you can excel in this role. Let's talk about what's blocking you."
"Stop complaining and start working!"	"Thanks for your feedback. Let's talk about your concerns and how we can address them."
"I don't want to hear any excuses!"	"I understand that challenges come up. Let's focus on finding solutions together."

Parents and Children

Violent Communication	Nonviolent Communication
"You never listen to me!"	"I feel frustrated when I don't feel heard. Can we talk about it?"
"Why can't you be more like your sibling?"	"You have your own strengths. Let's focus on those."
"You're such a disappointment!"	"I'm worried about some of your choices. Can we talk about how you're feeling?"
"Stop being so lazy and finish your homework!"	"I can see you're finding your homework hard. How can I help?"
"You always make a mess of things!"	"I noticed things are a bit messy. Can we tidy up together?"
"You're grounded for life if you do that again!"	"I'm worried about your behavior. Let's talk about the consequences and how to avoid them."
"You'll never amount to anything if you keep this up!"	"I believe in you. Let's set some goals together to help you succeed."
"Why do you always have to be so difficult?"	"I feel overwhelmed when we disagree. Can we find a better way to talk?"
"You're just being dramatic!"	"I can see you're upset. I want to understand how you feel."
"If you don't stop crying, I'll give you something to cry about!"	"I can see you're really upset. Let's take a moment and talk about what's bothering you."

Partners

Violent Communication	Nonviolent Communication
"You never appreciate anything I do!"	"I feel unappreciated when my efforts go unnoticed. Can we talk about how we show appreciation?"
"Why can't you just be more supportive?"	"I need more support from you during tough times. Can we talk about how you can help?"
"You always make everything about you!"	"I feel overlooked when conversations focus on one person. Can we make sure we both share?"
"You're so selfish!"	"I feel hurt when my needs aren't considered. Can we find a balance?"
"I can't believe you did that again!"	"I'm concerned about this coming up again. Can we talk about what's happening and how to fix it?"
"You're impossible to talk to!"	"I feel frustrated when we can't communicate well. Let's find a better way to talk about our feelings."
"You always ruin our plans!"	"I feel disappointed when our plans change at the last minute. Can we talk about how to handle changes?"
"You don't care about my feelings!"	"I need you to understand how I feel better. Can we talk about it?"
"You're just being dramatic!"	"I can see you feel strongly about this. I want to understand your side better."
"If you loved me, you would do this!"	"I'd feel more loved if we could work on this together. Can we talk about what we both need?"